Bouhedma National Park Geospatial Database Metadata

WWF Talent Academy 2026 – Biodiversity Series · Official Technical Metadata Datasheet (WDPA / UNEP-WCMC Standard)

Note: Official technical sheet prepared according to UNEP-WCMC international standards and the WWF North Africa BHD26-COM-CODE data dictionary.

Description:	The Bouhedma National Park geospatial database compiles all geographic, ecological, and biodiversity monitoring data collected during the **WWF Talent Academy 2026** field camp (Savanna Session, September 14–19, 2026). Bouhedma National Park (Central Tunisia) preserves North Africa's last pre-Saharan savanna dominated by ***Vachellia tortilis*** (formerly *Acacia raddiana*) and serves as the flagship reintroduction center for threatened Saharan megafauna: the Scimitar-horned Oryx (*Oryx dammah*), Dorcas Gazelle (*Gazella dorcas*), Dama Gazelle (*Nanger dama*), Barbary Sheep (*Ammotragus lervia*), and North African Ostrich (*Struthio camelus*). The database comprises 24 layers across 5 thematic days: park infrastructure and zoning, large herbivore surveys, carnivore camera trapping, nocturnal entomology, small mammal trapping, and phytoecological dendrometry.
Citation(s):	WWF North Africa & DGF (2026), *Bouhedma National Park Geospatial & Ecological Database – WWF Talent Academy 2026* [Online Dataset], Tunis, Tunisia: WWF North Africa & General Directorate of Forests. UNEP-WCMC and IUCN (2026), *Protected Planet: The World Database on Protected Areas (WDPA) - Site ID 13962*, Cambridge, UK: UNEP-WCMC and IUCN. Available at: www.protectedplanet.net.
Other cited references:	• WWF North Africa (2026). *Code Guide & Data Dictionary – Biodiversity Monitoring & Human-Wildlife Coexistence (BHD26-COM-CODE)*. • Riahi, O. (2021). *Contribution of GIS in the Environmental Monitoring of a Tunisian Biosphere Reserve (Bou Hedma National Park)*. Springer Water. • Le Floc'h, E., Boulos, L. & Véla, E. (2010). *Annotated Synonymic Catalogue of the Flora of Tunisia*. National Gene Bank, Tunis. • UNEP-WCMC (2019). *User Manual for the World Database on Protected Areas 1.6*. Cambridge, UK.
Temporal scale:	Field collection campaign: September 14 to 19, 2026 (WWF Talent Academy). Designation history: UNESCO-MAB Biosphere Reserve designated in 1977; National Park legally established in 1980.
Geographic extent:	National and regional: Central Tunisia, Governorates of Sidi Bouzid and Gafsa. Ecosystem: Pre-Saharan *Vachellia tortilis* savanna, Esparto grass steppes (*Stipa tenacissima*), and rocky limestone slopes of Djebel Bouhedma.
Additional information:	Each vector layer is documented according to the WWF Talent Academy data dictionary and matched to standardized attribute tables compliant with WDPA specifications. Distributed in **GeoJSON** and **ESRI Shapefile** formats with UTF-8 encoding and WGS 84 (EPSG:4326) CRS.
Purpose of creation:	1. Map and evaluate population statuses of reintroduced and wild wildlife. 2. Monitor human-wildlife coexistence, zonation (conservation core, buffer zones, enclosures, roads, and wildlife corridors). 3. Provide a rigorous geospatial dataset for interactive StoryMaps, GIS analysis (QGIS/ArcGIS), and open bioacoustic archiving on Zenodo. 4. Deliver practical field conservation training to WWF Talent Academy researchers.

Creation methodology:	Standardized protocols conducted during the September 2026 academy: • **Herbivore Census (Day 2)**: Direct motorized survey along road tracks led by Marie Petretto (Marwell Wildlife). • **Bat Sampling (Day 2)**: Ultra-fine mist netting, continuous 10–15 min checks, morphometrics, non-lethal swabs, and same-night release led by Khaled Ferchichi (Helmholtz Institute for One Health). • **Carnivore Trapping (Day 3)**: Indirect signs survey and 24/7 infrared motion-sensor camera traps deployed by Dr. Haithem El-Farhati and Jamel Jrijer. • **Nocturnal Entomology (Day 3)**: High-intensity white sheet light trapping (strict quota: max 5 specimens/species/night) led by Wael Ben Aba (WWF NA). • **Rodents & Bio-Index Transect (Day 4)**: Sherman/Tomahawk live-capture cage traps (peanut butter & sardine bait) and synchronized 3-person line-transects (0.5m spacing) led by Faouz Kilani and Dr. Haithem El-Farhati. • **Phytoecology & Dendrometry (Day 5)**: Nested quadrats (0.5m x 0.5m to 10m x 10m) and 10m linear dendrometric transects measuring *Vachellia tortilis* and *Stipa tenacissima* structural dimensions led by Dr. Alaeddine Rouissi.
Version management:	Version 1.0 (October 2026). Verified and consolidated following cross-check between field datasheets and GPS logs.
Category:	Protected Areas, Ecological Biodiversity Monitoring, Pre-Saharan Savanna, Human-Wildlife Coexistence.
Keywords:	Bouhedma National Park, WWF, Vachellia tortilis, Oryx dammah, Gazella dorcas, Struthio camelus, Ammotragus lervia, Camera traps, Mist nets, Bio-index transect, Dendrometry, UNESCO-MAB.
Quality and limitations:	• **Horizontal accuracy**: Logged with GPS receivers under WGS 84 (metric precision ~3–5 m). • **Vertical accuracy**: GPS elevation indicative in Z. • **Sensitive data confidentiality**: Under international IUCN/WWF guidelines, exact coordinates of poaching-vulnerable taxa (Striped Hyena, Barbary Sheep, Caracal) are restricted and reserved for Park conservation authorities.
Maintenance frequency:	Annual or following WWF / DGF seasonal ecological monitoring sessions.
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Formats and distribution:	GeoJSON (.geojson), ESRI Shapefile (.shp, .dbf, .prj, .shx), CSV/XLSX tabular data, JSON metadata (.meta.json).
Spatial Reference System:	WGS 1984 (EPSG:4326) · Geographic decimal degrees.
Bounding Box (BBOX):	**West:** 9.2622° E | **East:** 9.6850° E | **South:** 34.2855° N | **North:** 34.6105° N
Metadata standard:	UNEP-WCMC WDPA Version 1.6 Standard & ISO 19115 / Darwin Core (GBIF) profile.